

Drake Thorne

Network Platform Engineer | Haymarket, NSW

contact@drakethorne.com | drakethorne.com | linkedin.com/in/drakethorne | github.com/drake-thorne

SUMMARY

Network Platform Engineer with 4+ years of experience designing, automating, and operating network and infrastructure environments across on-premises and cloud platforms. Well versed in building scalable solutions using Ansible, Terraform, AWS, Python, Git, and NetBox. Experienced building and operating automation platforms on Linux using Docker, Kubernetes (Amazon EKS), Infrastructure as Code, and Git-based CI/CD pipelines.

EXPERIENCE

Network Platform Engineer | Nine Entertainment

Aug 2024 – Present

- Developed and delivered network automation frameworks for multiple full-site EVPN-VXLAN spine-leaf fabrics across Juniper QFX/EX and Fortinet platforms, leveraging Juniper Mist, Ansible, Python, and GitHub Actions. Automated traffic draining, BGP policies, peering, route maps, ESI-LAG, IRB/VRF management, and port allocation.
- Developed and maintained Ansible automation frameworks and API-driven workflows (REST API/GraphQL) integrating NetBox, Infoblox, LogicMonitor, ServiceNow, Cisco ISE, and Cisco Catalyst Center, enabling scalable infrastructure management across 1500+ network devices while significantly reducing manual toil.
- Engineered repeatable microservices deployments on Amazon EKS via Helm charts and Kubernetes manifests. Included NetBox (source of truth for 1500+ devices), Oxidized, AWX, and self-hosted Docker Registry with pull-through cache.
- Built an OpenTofu CI/CD pipeline to manage NetBox config contexts and device local context data. Used GitHub Actions to show planned diff and apply changes on merge.
- Developed event-driven, serverless AWS pipelines connecting Basware and Microsoft D365, using AWS Lambdas written in Golang. Managed infrastructure such as EventBridge, SQS, API Gateway, S3, and IAM roles via Terraform.
- Built and maintained Docker images for development containers and production execution environments using Ansible Builder and Git-based CI/CD workflows via GitHub Actions, publishing multi-architecture ARM64/AMD64 images to Amazon ECR.
- Led the end-to-end migration of enterprise DHCP infrastructure from Windows DHCP Server to Infoblox across all sites, developing Ansible automation for IPAM migration, DHCP scope provisioning, and VXLAN gateway updates. Provided post-migration operational support.
- Automated Amazon RDS lifecycle management processes using Ansible, reducing manual database provisioning and maintenance effort by approximately 50%.
- Automated credential lifecycle management across hundreds of Cisco IOS and NX-OS devices using Ansible and 1Password.
- Designed and deployed automated ERSPAN unicast monitoring workflows integrated with ExtraHop, increasing network traffic visibility to approximately 80% of RX traffic.
- Monitored and remediated containerised workloads on Amazon Elastic Kubernetes Service, diagnosing and resolving pod failures, performance bottlenecks, and cluster resource constraints.

Systems Administrator | Fin Design + Effects

Apr 2023 – Aug 2024

- Designed and delivered a centralized monitoring and telemetry platform across 500+ nodes using Graylog, Zabbix, Grafana, and Slack integrations, significantly improving observability and reducing incident response times.
- Developed Ansible-based automation for Linux fleet management across 50+ nodes, including configuration management, Cron jobs, patching, and operational maintenance.
- Built and implemented secure remote access infrastructure using Duo MFA, RADIUS/Active Directory authentication, L2TP/IPsec VPNs, Apache, and Nginx reverse proxy technologies.
- Managed hybrid infrastructure environments spanning Windows Server, VMware, TrueNAS, Google Cloud Platform, and Linux systems, supporting business-critical production workloads.

- Designed, deployed, and maintained Layer 2 and Layer 3 network infrastructure across Brocade and Cisco platforms, including VLANs, VRFs, LAG/LACP, NAT, and routing instances.
- Implemented network security controls through ACL management, Barracuda firewall administration, and PowerShell-based encryption automation to strengthen infrastructure security posture.

EDUCATION

Diploma of Information Technology | Macquarie University

Graduated 2022

WAM: 81.875 (Distinction)

Academic Integrity Certification | Macquarie Association of Computing Students (MACS)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python, Bash, PowerShell, REST APIs

Automation & IaC: Ansible, AWX, Terraform, Git, GitHub Actions

Containers & Platforms: Docker, Kubernetes, Helm, Linux

Cloud: AWS (EKS, EC2, ECR, RDS, S3)

Networking: NetBox, Cisco IOS/NX-OS, Juniper, Mist, FortiGate, Brocade

Monitoring & Operations: LogicMonitor, Infoblox, Wireshark, Nginx, Apache